Daily Economic Briefing

Thursday 15 October 2026 | Window: Tue 13 Oct 2026 20:00 ET – Wed 14 Oct 2026 20:20 ET (Wed 14 Oct close/AH) | Research cutoff 14 Oct 2026, 20:20 ET | Edition 42

Assumptions, corrections and status this edition

- AP's "How major US stock indexes fared" wire again returned HTTP 403 on both a direct fetch and syndication mirrors. Wednesday's index closes below are recovered via CNBC's live market wrap and a Yahoo Finance/TheStreet recap, cross-checked against the SPY ETF's own close[5] and reconciled arithmetically against Tuesday's logged closes (S&P 500 7,805.45, Dow 51,670.10, Nasdaq Composite 27,204.38, Russell 2000 2,783.37) — a different recovery method than edition 41's clean syndication-mirror hit.
- Henry Hub's Tuesday base was revised a second time by the vendor's own historical table (logged $3.319 at edition 41, now shown as $3.283) — Wednesday's %-change is genuinely ambiguous between +0.18% and -0.90% depending which base is used; both reported below, neither resolved.
- The "vendor retroactively revises a logged close" trap flagged on oil at edition 41 recurred on WTI's own Tuesday %-change (logged +1.10%, now shown +0.43%) and, for the first time, surfaced on FX: Tuesday's EUR/USD and GBP/USD %-changes both drifted slightly from what was logged, and USD/JPY's drifted materially (-0.39% to -0.20%).
- Kitco's live gold/silver spot quotes (+0.83%/+0.75%) directly contradict both Wednesday's futures settlement (-1.06%/-6.14%) and Kitco's own published headlines ("gold falls below $4,100, silver plunges 6%"). Treated as a mistimed/rebound quote, not Wednesday's close; futures settlement used as the authoritative figure below.
- China's September CPI/PPI — pending for three straight editions — has finally posted (CPI +0.9% y/y, PPI +5.0% y/y), though via gov.cn's English-language NBS-sourced portal rather than a direct stats.gov.cn fetch, which failed again.
- zerogex's SPX dealer-gamma feed changed failure mode a third time: after two editions of an auth-gated API error and a blank page, Wednesday's front-end loaded a populated page shell with every metric left as an unresolved placeholder dash. Still unusable.
- Edition 41's two disclosed inferences — JPMorgan's EPS framing vs. preview consensus, and Wells Fargo/Citigroup's credit-provision rationale for their post-earnings selloffs — remain uncorroborated by any dated article. A competing yield-driven explanation for the bank-sector angle surfaced this edition (10-year near 5.30% ahead of Tuesday's reports); it too is not confirmed to the specific stock reactions by name.

60-second read

1. September CPI ran hot — headline +0.6% m/m/+3.7% y/y, core +0.3% m/m/+2.6% y/y, both above the approx. 3.6%/2.5% consensus[1][2] — and drove the broadest risk-off session in weeks: S&P 500 -1.11%, Nasdaq Composite -1.88%, Russell 2000 -1.9%, VIX +10.5% to 16.87, and October-hike odds jumped from approx. 19% to approx. 29% (December little-changed near 78%)[21].
2. The Dow was the one major average to hold up (-0.09%), as money rotated defensively into Health Care (+2.53%) and Staples (+2.22%) while Technology (-2.98%) led 8-of-11 sectors lower[6] — CoreWeave (-15.46%) and Oracle (-8.83%) bore the brunt of a renewed AI-infrastructure-funding-stress selloff[13][14][15].
3. Bank earnings diverged sharply: Bank of America's GAAP EPS slipped to $1.08 on a $1.2bn regulatory-settlement charge (stock -4.76%), while Morgan Stanley beat cleanly on both revenue and EPS yet still fell -2.75% amid the broad selloff[7][9].
4. Commodities swung hard on the hawkish repricing: silver futures plunged -6.14%, gold futures fell -1.06%, and the Treasury curve flattened (2-year +3bp to 4.82%, 10-year -2bp to 5.19%, 30-year -4bp to 5.52%) as front-end hike odds rose even as risk-off demand supported the long end[38][36][44].
5. Bumble's unexplained two-session rally (Mon +49.6%, Tue +56.6%) resolved: a definitive $1.3bn all-cash buyout by Ithaca Holdings at $6.05/share, confirmed via the company's own merger filing — not a stock split[18][19].

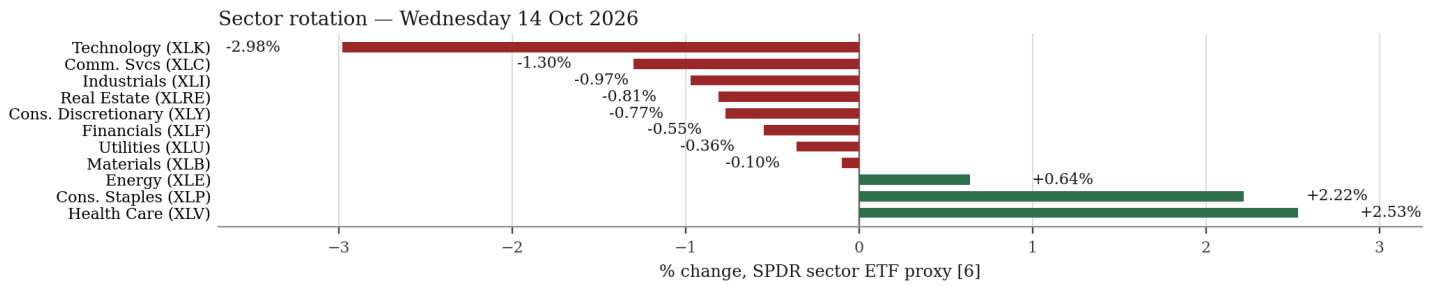
1. Market recap

S&P 500	Dow Jones	Nasdaq Composite	Russell 2000	VIX	10Y Treasury
7,718.94	**51,621.48**	**26,692.87**	**2,729.53**	**16.87**	**5.19%**
-1.11%	-0.09%	-1.88%	-1.90%	+10.48%	-2bp

WTI crude	Gold (fut.)	DXY
$94.80	**$4,132.95**	**102.34**
+0.70%	-1.06%	+0.36%

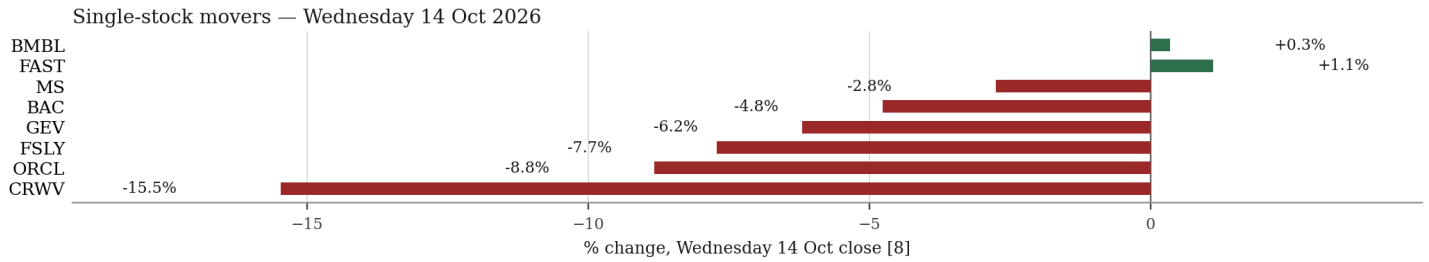
A hotter-than-expected September CPI print[1] reset the market's rate-path assumptions and triggered the broadest-based equity selloff in several weeks[3][4], though the damage was uneven: the Dow's defensive/financials-light composition held it essentially flat while the Nasdaq Composite and Russell 2000 both fell nearly 2%, tracking a sharp Technology-sector drawdown[6]. Volatility spiked hard — VIX +10.5%, VIX9D +21.7%[46] — and the October-hike probability on prediction markets nearly doubled intraday[21]. Commodities and rates told a cross-current story: precious metals sold off sharply on the hawkish repricing while the long end of the Treasury curve actually richened, a classic flattening move as front-end rate fears met risk-off demand for duration[44].

2. Equities and earnings



Three of 11 SPDR sectors closed green[6]: Health Care (XLV +2.53%) and Consumer Staples (XLP +2.22%) led as capital rotated defensively, with Energy (XLE +0.64%) the only cyclical sector higher. Technology (XLK -2.98%) was the clear laggard, followed by Communication Services (XLC -1.30%) and Industrials (XLI -0.97%) — consistent with a renewed AI-infrastructure-capex-funding-stress theme hitting the largest tech-adjacent names (see movers below). The Dow's resilience (-0.09% vs. S&P -1.11%, Nasdaq -1.88%) owes directly to this mix: its heavier weighting toward Health Care/Staples names offset the Technology drag that dominated the cap-weighted Nasdaq.

Single-stock movers



Ticker	Move	Driver
CRWV	-15.46%	AI-infrastructure funding-stress selloff, tied by CNBC's same-day wrap to continuing fallout from reports that OpenAI's annualized revenue run-rate (approx. $50bn) came in well below earlier-reported figures (approx. $70bn); no Oct-14-specific dated article independently pinned the exact trigger[13][14]
ORCL	-8.83%	Same AI-capex-funding-stress theme per CNBC's same-day mention; exact Oct-14 trigger not independently dated[14][15]
FSLY	-7.72%	No dated driver found — a 4th consecutive unexplained session (Fri +15.86%, Mon -9.80%, Tue +2.50%, Wed -7.72%); see Annex A[17]
GEV	-6.20%	No dated driver found; next earnings not due until approx. 28 Oct; see Annex A[16]
BAC	-4.76%	Q3 GAAP EPS $1.08 (preview-consensus aggregators had clustered approx. $1.11-1.18, an unconfirmed framing) on a $1.2bn regulatory-settlement charge that cut EPS $0.17; adjusted EPS approx. $1.25 per the company's own disclosure[7][8]
MS	-2.75%	Q3 EPS $3.03 (vs. an Earnings Whispers consensus of $3.01) on $20.3bn revenue (vs. a Zacks consensus of $19.63bn) — a clean beat on both lines per the 8-K, yet fell with the broad market[9][10]
FAST	+1.11%	Q3 daily sales +15.5% y/y, operating margin +90bp to 21.5%, per the 8-K; exact EPS-vs-consensus comparison not obtained[11][12]
BMBL	+0.34%	Settled at $5.97, just under the newly-confirmed $6.05/share Ithaca Holdings all-cash buyout price ($1.3bn deal, announced Tue 13 Oct) — resolves the prior two sessions' unexplained jumps; confirmed not a stock split[18][19][20]

Bank of America's and Morgan Stanley's EPS-vs-consensus comparisons above rely on secondary preview-consensus aggregators rather than a dated post-earnings "beat/miss" article and should be read as disclosed inferences, consistent with the caution carried from edition 41's JPMorgan item. No analyst rating or price-target action dated specifically to Wednesday 14 October could be confirmed for any name despite a genuine search — continuing an intermittent empty-result pattern seen in several recent editions.

3. Macro, policy and rates

September CPI printed hot across both measures: headline +0.6% m/m / +3.7% y/y (prior +0.4% m/m), core +0.3% m/m / +2.6% y/y (up from 2.4% in August), both above the Dow Jones consensus of approx. 3.6%/2.5%[1][2] (one secondary preview had cited a slightly different approx. 3.6-3.7%/2.4% range; the Dow Jones figure is used as the more credible consensus citation, with the disagreement disclosed). Gasoline (+9.1% m/m) accounted for over half of the monthly all-items increase[1]. **Rate-path odds** repriced sharply hawkish on the print: DeFi Rate's Kalshi/Polymarket-blended aggregator (fresh snapshot, Wed 14 Oct 7:06pm ET) showed October 27-28 hike odds at approx. 29% (hold approx. 70%, cut approx. 2%), up from approx. 19% Tuesday, with December 8-9 hike odds little-changed near approx. 78%[21]. A secondary claim (Seeking Alpha) that CME FedWatch's own October-hike probability jumped to 49.3% could not be independently verified and conflicts with the directly-fetched DeFi Rate figure — reported as unconfirmed[22]. Direct Kalshi and CME FedWatch fetches both failed again (429/timeout), now six and multiple consecutive editions respectively.

Standing facts, re-verified fresh: Kevin Warsh remains Fed Chair, confirmed directly against the Board of Governors bios page for a 12th straight edition[23]. Next FOMC meeting 27-28 October 2026 (decision/press conference 28 Oct, 2:30pm ET — this specific time sub-detail was not re-displayed on the Fed's own calendar page this pass and is carried forward unchanged, to be re-confirmed directly next edition), confirmed via federalreserve.gov's FOMC calendar page; December meeting 8-9 December[24]. Bank of England's next decision remains Thursday 5 November 2026, confirmed directly[25]. Bank of Japan's next meeting remains 29-30 October 2026, confirmed directly against boj.or.jp's own schedule page[26]. No US government shutdown is in effect; funded through 11 December 2026 via H.R. 6500 — this edition's confirmation relies on secondary corroboration (a whitehouse.gov briefing-room fetch did not surface funding-specific content either way) rather than a clean direct hit, a step down from edition 41's method[27][28]. **China's September CPI/PPI has finally posted** after three editions pending: CPI +0.9% y/y (+0.2% m/m, up from +0.8% in August), PPI +5.0% y/y (up sharply from +3.8% in August, the fastest PPI rise since June 2022), driven by fuel costs (gasoline +16.6% y/y); food prices -1.7% y/y[29][30]. The primary stats.gov.cn page itself remained unreachable (stale, August-only listing); this print is sourced to gov.cn's English-language NBS-attributed release, corroborated by CNBC.

4. Commodities and FX

Instrument	Level	Chg	Note
WTI crude (Nov '26, CLX6)	$94.80	+0.70%	Computed off Tue close $94.14; vendor's own logged Tuesday %-change was revised 1.10%→0.43% since edition 41[33]
Brent crude (Dec '26, LCOZ6)	$106.06	+0.35%	Tuesday base clean, matches edition 41's logged -0.90% exactly[34]
Henry Hub nat. gas (Nov '26, NGX6)	$3.289	+0.18% / -0.90%*	*Ambiguous: Tuesday base itself revised $3.319→$3.283 since edition 41; both computed changes shown, unresolved[35]

Gold futures (Dec '26, GCZ6)	$4,132.95	-1.06%	Kitco spot (+0.83%) conflicts with this and its own headlines; treated as mistimed, futures used[36][37]
Silver futures (Dec '26, SIZ6)	$55.873	-6.14%	Sharpest single-session commodity move logged this edition; Kitco spot conflicts similarly[38][37]
Copper (Westmetall cash)	$14,751.00/t	+0.07%	Clean reconciliation, Tuesday base matches logged value exactly[39]
DXY	102.342	+0.36%	Clean[40]
EUR/USD	1.1195	-0.04%	Tuesday base drifted 0.41%→0.39% since edition 41[41]
GBP/USD	1.3230	-0.19%	Tuesday base drifted 0.37%→0.35% since edition 41[42]
USD/JPY	157.98	-0.21%	Tuesday base drifted materially, -0.39%→-0.20%; moved opposite DXY, resuming the divergence pattern after a 3-session pause[43]
2-year Treasury	4.82%	+3bp	TextView/CSV endpoints agree exactly, 7th straight clean edition[44]
10-year Treasury	5.19%	-2bp	Clean[44]
30-year Treasury	5.52%	-4bp	Clean[44]

Precious metals sold off sharply on the hot-CPI-driven hawkish repricing, with silver's -6.14% the largest single-session commodity move logged by this report in recent editions; oil firmed modestly instead, likely reflecting the same inflation impulse (gasoline was the single largest driver of September's CPI beat[1]) rather than a demand story. The Treasury curve flattened: the 2-year rose 3bp on firmer front-end hike odds while the 10- and 30-year richened slightly, consistent with risk-off duration demand offsetting the inflation print at the long end. The vendor-revision pattern that first hit oil and gas at edition 41 has now broadened to all three FX crosses tracked, with USD/JPY's revision the most material; disclosed rather than silently resolved per standing practice. SOFR's Tuesday 13 Oct fixing posted as expected at 3.89% (effective date 13 Oct); Wednesday's own fixing had not yet posted as of this window's cutoff, expected Thursday morning[45].

5. Derivatives, volatility and positioning

The VIX complex spiked hard on the CPI-driven selloff, all series carrying a same-day (Wed 14 Oct 16:15 ET) `last_trade_time` and matching a manual recomputation of day-over-day %-change exactly, with neither of the feed's two known intermittent bugs recurring this edition[46]: VIX 16.87 (+10.48%), VIX9D 14.59 (+21.68%), VIX3M 18.79 (+4.62%), VIX6M 20.49 (+2.86%), VVIX 94.45 (+10.62%), SKEW 157.30 (+1.65%). The VIX9D-vs-VIX inversion narrowed further to -2.28 from -3.28 Tuesday — a third consecutive narrowing session, though this time driven by a sharp front-end vol spike rather than a gentle drift, and still not treated as a confirmed trend. No dated article was found tying the spike's magnitude specifically to the CPI print beyond coincident timing; the CPI is reported as the most plausible driver, not an independently confirmed causal claim. zerogex's SPX dealer-gamma feed remained unusable, now in a third distinct failure mode across three editions (auth-gated/blank at 40-41, a populated shell of unresolved placeholder dashes at 42)[47]. CFTC Commitments of Traders: no new report posted inside this window, as expected; the next release remains Friday 16 October 2026 (covering Tuesday 13 October data), confirmed directly against cftc.gov's release schedule with no delay notice[32]. No single-stock options-flow or skew commentary dated specifically to 13-14 October could be found for the reporting banks, JNJ, UnitedHealth or Fastly despite a genuine search — continuing a now-familiar low-yield pattern on this sub-item.

6. The day ahead

Date	Event	Consensus / context
Thu 15 Oct, approx. 2:00am ET	TSMC Q3 2026 earnings call	Falls just after this edition's cutoff; prior guidance range revenue $44.6-45.8bn, gross margin 65-67%; quiet period ended 14 Oct[31]
Thu 15 Oct, 8:30am ET	September PPI	Per BLS's own October schedule[30]
Fri 16 Oct, 8:30am ET	Import/Export Price Indexes	Per BLS's own October schedule[30]
Fri 16 Oct, 3:30pm ET	CFTC Commitments of Traders	Covers Tue 13 Oct data; confirmed on schedule[32]
Fri 23 Oct	Univ. of Michigan final October consumer sentiment	Preliminary read was 46.3, a five-month low
Tue 27 - Wed 28 Oct	FOMC meeting	Decision/press conference 28 Oct, 2:30pm ET; October hike odds approx. 29% as of this edition[24][21]
Thu 29 - Fri 30 Oct	Bank of Japan meeting	Confirmed directly against boj.or.jp[26]
Fri 30 Oct, 8:30am ET	Q3 Employment Cost Index	Per BLS's own schedule

Sector setup we take into Thursday's session

- Watch for follow-through in the defensive rotation (Health Care, Staples) versus Technology given the CPI-driven hawkish repricing; October hike odds near 29% leave room to move further on Thursday's PPI print.
- TSMC's earnings call lands just hours after this edition's cutoff — the next major single-name catalyst; watch for the currency/share-basis consensus mismatch flagged in prior editions when comparing EPS figures across outlets.
- Fastly and GE Vernova both remain unexplained movers across this and recent sessions — watch for a delayed driver.
- Silver's -6.14% plunge is this report's largest single-session commodity move in recent editions — watch for follow-through or a reversal as the precious-metals complex digests the hawkish repricing.

Annex A — Data points sought but not verified this edition

- Fastly's Wednesday -7.72% move remains unexplained for a 4th consecutive session despite a genuine search; a Sept 2 Schaeffer's Research short-squeeze-potential piece is suggestive context only, not a same-day driver[48].
- GE Vernova's -6.20% Wednesday move: no dated driver found; next earnings not due until approx. 28 October.
- Any analyst rating or price-target action dated specifically to 14 October: none found for any name despite a genuine search.
- JPMorgan's Q3 EPS ($5.57) "beat vs. miss" framing against preview-consensus estimates (approx. $5.86-5.94): still not confirmed or corrected by any dated post-earnings article.
- Wells Fargo's and Citigroup's credit-provision rise as the specific cause of their Tuesday selloffs: still not confirmed by a dated article; a competing yield-driven, sector-wide explanation (10-year near 5.30% ahead of Tuesday's reports, the big-five banks reportedly down approx. $270bn combined from summer peaks) is equally plausible and itself not tied to the specific stock moves by name[49].
- Single-stock options-flow or skew commentary for JPM, GS, WFC, C, BAC, MS, JNJ, UnitedHealth or Fastly dated to 13-14 October: none found.
- A dated article tying Wednesday's sharp VIX/VVIX spike specifically to the CPI print, beyond coincident timing: not found.
- Seeking Alpha's claim of a 49.3% CME FedWatch October-hike probability post-CPI: could not be independently verified; conflicts with DeFi Rate's directly-fetched approx. 29%.
- Fastenal's exact Q3 EPS figure and a clean consensus comparison: only revenue/margin detail was obtained.
- NYSE/Nasdaq closing breadth (formal table): not obtainable, a standing gap; the 3-of-11-sectors-green SPDR read is used as the best available proxy.

Annex B — Sources

- [1] BLS, Consumer Price Index Summary, Sept 2026 (bls.gov/news.release/cpi.nr0.htm)
- [2] CNBC, Sept CPI coverage and Dow Jones consensus, 14 Oct 2026
- [3] CNBC "Stock market today" live-blog, 14 Oct 2026 session wrap
- [4] Yahoo Finance/TheStreet, "Stock Market Today (Oct. 14, 2026)"
- [5] Stockanalysis.com, SPY ETF price history
- [6] Stockanalysis.com, SPDR sector ETF price-history tables (XLV, XLP, XLE, XLB, XLU, XLF, XLY, XLRE, XLI, XLC, XLK)
- [7] Bank of America, Q3 2026 8-K (SEC EDGAR)
- [8] Stockanalysis.com, BAC price history
- [9] Morgan Stanley, Q3 2026 8-K (SEC EDGAR)
- [10] Stockanalysis.com, MS price history
- [11] Fastenal, Q3 2026 8-K (SEC EDGAR)
- [12] Stockanalysis.com, FAST price history
- [13] Stockanalysis.com, CRWV price history
- [14] CNBC, same-day market wrap (CoreWeave/Oracle decline mentions)
- [15] Stockanalysis.com, ORCL price history
- [16] Stockanalysis.com, GEV price history
- [17] Stockanalysis.com, FSLY price history
- [18] Bumble Inc., merger agreement 8-K (SEC EDGAR)
- [19] BNN Bloomberg / gvwire.com, Bumble-Ithaca Holdings coverage
- [20] Stockanalysis.com, BMBL price history
- [21] DeFi Rate, Kalshi/Polymarket-blended Fed-odds aggregator (defirate.com)
- [22] Seeking Alpha, CME FedWatch 49.3% claim (unverified, flagged)
- [23] Federalreserve.gov, Board of Governors bios page
- [24] Federalreserve.gov, FOMC meeting calendars page
- [25] Bankofengland.co.uk, upcoming MPC decision dates
- [26] Boj.or.jp, Monetary Policy Meeting schedule
- [27] Whitehouse.gov, briefing-room index page
- [28] Secondary news coverage (Fox News, report.az), H.R. 6500 signing/funding status
- [29] Gov.cn, English-language NBS-sourced China CPI/PPI release, 14 Oct 2026
- [30] Bls.gov, monthly release schedule (2026/10_sched_list.htm)
- [31] TSMC Investor Relations, quarterly results page
- [32] CFTC.gov, release schedule page
- [33] Investing.com, WTI crude history table
- [34] Investing.com, Brent crude history table
- [35] Investing.com, Henry Hub natural gas (NGX6) history table
- [36] Investing.com, Gold futures (GCZ6) history table
- [37] Kitco, live gold/silver spot quotes
- [38] Investing.com, Silver futures (SIZ6) history table
- [39] Westmetall.com, copper cash settlement
- [40] Investing.com, DXY futures history table
- [41] Investing.com, EUR/USD history table
- [42] Investing.com, GBP/USD history table
- [43] Investing.com, USD/JPY history table
- [44] Home.treasury.gov, par-yield CSV and TextView endpoints
- [45] NY Fed Markets Data API, SOFR rates
- [46] CBOE, delayed-quotes JSON (cdn-api.cboe.com)
- [47] Zerogex.io, front-end page
- [48] Schaeffer's Research, FSLY short-squeeze-potential piece, 2 Sept 2026
- [49] TIKR/finviz, "Banks under pressure from spiking yields" context coverage

Method: every figure traces to a named source in Annex B; where sources disagreed, the better-corroborated figure was used and the conflict disclosed. Nothing estimated or filled from memory — unverifiable items are listed in Annex A. Not investment advice.